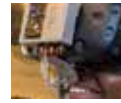




Powered chopsticks = salty food

Researchers have managed to develop powered chopsticks that can make food 1.5 times saltier. <https://digit.in/may22-23>



Temperature sensation in VR

Researchers have found that haptics could be the key to getting the temperature and other sensations in VR. <https://digit.in/may22-24>



SINKING COASTAL CITIES

It's going down.
Literally.

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By now, you would have heard a lot about climate change and other reckless uses of natural resources. Also, how it affects and will affect our lives in the future if humans continue to live the way they are right now. While the effects of these issues may not be directly visible to most individuals, the situation is becoming increasingly unsettling for most of this planet's population. One of the examples is in the form of the sinking coastal cities. Yes, you read it right. The coastal cities across the globe are going underwater at a rate that is much faster than what was initially anticipated.

A research paper titled 'Subsidence in Coastal Cities Throughout the World Observed by InSAR' published in the journal Geophysical Research Letters reported the findings which suggest that several major coastal cities can potentially be submerged earlier than we expected them to.

To carry out their research, scientists measured the subsidence rates of 99 coastal cities between 2015 and 2020 using the PS Interferometric Synthetic Aperture Radar method. The data gathered from the Sentinel-1 satellite supported this. The study of the data generated here was then studied systematically and the findings were finally presented suggesting that the subsidence rate of the coastal cities was faster than expected. This means that the land is going underwater faster than the sea levels are rising.

The regions affected the most by this phenomenon include South, Southeast, and East Asia. However, the rest of the world is not com-

pletely averse to this problem. Cities in North America, Africa, Europe and Australia are also facing similar issues, albeit at a relatively slower pace than their Asian counterparts. So, everyone is at risk of going underwater sooner or later.

What is different in this study is the model used to project the submergence of coastal cities. So far, we have primarily been reliant on the sea level model, which projected the time of submergence of coastal cities by taking into account the rate at which the water is rising in the major water bodies of the planet. This model is being used prominently to predict the rate at which coastal cities will be underwater. However, the other model of study, which makes its projections based on the rate at which the land is subsiding in the coastal cities, shows that its counterpart may have been generous in giving us more time until the doomsday.

We have seen campaigns talking about the melting polar ice caps and